LESSON PLAN · SCRATCH (GR 3–5) BEGINNER: SCRATCH GAME MAKERS

Lesson 3: Project: My Animated Name

Module 1 | 50 minutes | Project: sequences + events | Grades 3–5 · ages 8–10

Objective: Plan, build, test and share an interactive name project that uses events and sequences, with a green-flag reset script.

Success criteria

- Every letter reacts to a click.
- The green flag resets every letter.
- I tested my project and fixed at least one bug.

Key vocabulary

- **effect**: A Looks change such as colour, ghost or fisheye.
- **reset**: Putting a sprite back to how it should start.
- **test**: Running a program to check it works.
- **bug**: A mistake in code that makes it behave wrongly.

You will need

- Projector with Kitabash (lesson video, Code Lab)
- Devices: 1 per learner or pair
- Printed worksheet (optional)
- Printed project brief

Timed lesson plan (50 min)

Time	Stage	What happens
5 min	**Warm-up (unplugged)**	Letter actors game; introduce reset with “Green flag!”.
5 min	**Watch & plan**	Project video; students sketch what each letter will do on the project brief.
25 min	**Build**	Build-along steps, then own ideas. Check-in at 10 minutes: every student has at least one working letter.
7 min	**Test & peer feedback**	Swap seats: click a partner’s letters. Give “two stars and a wish”.
8 min	**Submit & reflect**	Complete the checklist, share or save, submit the link and reflection in Kitabash. Try the paint-your-initial puzzle.

Unplugged warm-up

Letter actors (5 min): five students each hold a letter card. The class “clicks” (taps a shoulder) and the letter does its action (spin, jump, wave). Then shout “Green flag!” — everyone resets.

Teaching the idea

The first project consolidates sequence and events. Each letter sprite has a click script (changes) and a green-flag reset script (sets values back). Emphasise building and testing one letter at a time.

Analogy: A reset script is like tidying the classroom at the end of the day so the next lesson starts fresh.

Live demo: Show a finished example with your own name. Click letters to show the variety, then click letters many times and show how messy it gets — add the reset script live.

Questions to ask

Ask	Listen for
What does your reset script need to set?	Colour effects, size, direction (and position if it moves).
How will you test it?	Press the flag, then click every letter twice.
What's one bug you found and fixed?	Any real example — celebrate debugging.

Differentiation

Support
Short names or initials are fine. Provide the three example scripts on a printed card; students can use the same action for two letters.

Stretch
Add a "when space key pressed" script that makes ALL letters do a group dance, or add a backdrop change when the last letter is clicked.

Common misconceptions

Misconception	How to fix it
The reset only needs to go on one letter	Each sprite has its own scripts — every letter needs its own reset.
change size by (100) sets the size to 100	"change" adds to the current value; "set" chooses the exact value.
If it worked once, it's finished	Test several times, in different orders, to find bugs.

Assessment

Project rubric (also on the project brief):

Criterion	1 · Beginning	2 · Developing	3 · Secure	4 · Excellent

Events	Few letters react to clicks	Some letters react to clicks	Every letter reacts to a click	Uses more than one kind of event (click, key, flag)
Sequences	Scripts are missing or don’t run	Scripts run, but steps are in a confusing order	Each script runs its steps in a clear order	Several steps combine into smooth animations
Reset	No reset script	Some letters reset	The green flag resets every letter	Reset also sets position and size so it always starts the same
Creativity	Copies the example only	Some own ideas	Each letter has its own idea	Surprising, polished ideas (sounds, effects, backdrop)
Testing & reflection	Not tested; no reflection	Tested a little; short reflection	Tested every letter; reflection explains a choice	Fixed bugs found in testing; reflection explains what was learned

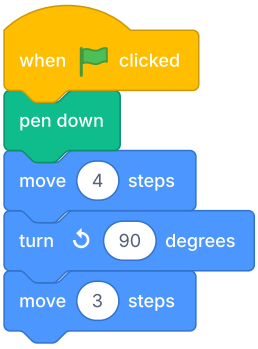
Exit ticket
Write one bug you found today and how you fixed it.

Homework
Show your animated name to someone at home. Ask them which letter is best and write down their idea for improving it.

Answer key — Kitabash activities

1. Paint your initial (perform · block code)

One solution:



2. Code Lab: add a reset script (perform · code lab)

Goals checked: Click still works · Green flag resets the size · Green flag clears the colour

One solution:

K





3. Where does each block belong? (perform · categorize)

Reset script (when green flag clicked): clear graphic effects, set size to 100%, point in direction 90
Click script (when this sprite clicked): change color effect by 25, change size by 30, start sound Pop

4. Why reset? (perform · multiple choice)

Answer: So the project starts the same way every time

5. The design cycle (perform · ordering)

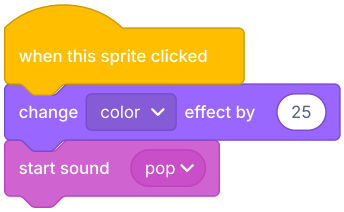
Order: Plan what each letter will do → Build one letter’s script → Test it by clicking → Fix anything that doesn’t work → Share it with a friend

6. Project: My Animated Name (probe · code lab)

Goals checked: At least 3 letters · Every letter reacts to a click · Every letter has a reset

Example project:

A



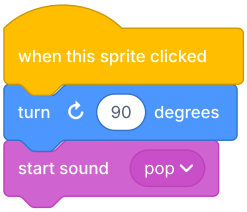


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Answer key — worksheet

1. **My letters:** Students' own plans — each letter should have a clear action.
2. **My reset script:** Clear graphic effects, set size to 100% and point in direction 90 (plus go to x/y if letters move).
3. **Change or set?:** CHANGE · SET
4. **Two stars and a wish:** Kind, specific feedback.

Kitabash original curriculum. Scratch is a project of the Scratch Foundation in collaboration with the MIT Media Lab; this course is not affiliated with or endorsed by them.